

KAREEM TAMER ISMAEL

Aspiring Penetration Tester | Cybersecurity Student (B.Sc. Computer Science)

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Cybersecurity student and aspiring Penetration Tester with hands-on experience in web application and network penetration testing, vulnerability assessment, and red-teaming methodology. Solved **30+** PortSwigger Web Security Academy labs and progressed **15%** through the Hack the Box CPTS path. Gained enterprise exposure through a **1-month** offensive-security internship at a national financial-market infrastructure provider (MCDR/EGX), combined with a software-development foundation in Python and C++ for custom tool building and manual exploit development.

TECHNICAL SKILLS & CORE COMPETENCIES

- **Penetration Testing & Red Teaming:** Web application testing (OWASP Top 10), network exploitation, vulnerability assessment, reconnaissance & OSINT, privilege escalation (Linux/Windows), Active Directory enumeration.
- **Vulnerability Classes:** SQL injection, XSS, IDOR, SSRF, CSRF, file inclusion/upload flaws, authentication & business-logic flaws.
- **Tools:** Burp Suite (Pro/Community), Nmap (NSE scripting), Metasploit, Wireshark, Bettercap, Hydra, Enum4linux, tcpdump, SQLmap, Gobuster, Nessus, VirusTotal.
- **Programming:** Python (Scapy, CustomTkinter), C++, SQL, HTML/CSS.
- **Systems:** Kali Linux, Ubuntu Server, Windows Server/Client, VMware Workstation Pro, VirtualBox.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE & INTERNSHIPS

Cybersecurity Intern — Offensive Security & SOC

Aug 2026 – Sep 2026

Misr for Central Clearing, Depository & Registry (MCDR) & Egyptian Stock Exchange (EGX) — Cairo, Egypt

- Performed vulnerability assessments across enterprise network segments and internet-facing web assets, triaging findings by severity (critical/high/medium) to prioritize remediation.
- Executed simulated adversarial attack scenarios — including firewall-rule evasion and endpoint-bypass attempts — to stress-test perimeter defenses under realistic attacker conditions.
- Cross-referenced SIEM alerts, firewall logs, and IDS/IPS output during SOC shadowing to benchmark detection coverage against current offensive tradecraft.

Graduation Project Team Lead

2026 – Present

Egyptian Chinese University (ECU) — Cairo, Egypt

- Lead a team of **10** students in technical architecture design, scope definition, and milestone planning for a senior cybersecurity capstone project.
- Structuring project across **6** planned modules covering threat modeling, vulnerability assessment, and attack-defense simulation, targeting completion by **December 2026**.

Cybersecurity Trainee (90 Hours)

Jun 2025 – Sep 2025

National Telecommunication Institute (NTI) — Cairo, Egypt

- Completed **90 hours** of practical training in network defense strategies, threat analysis, and attack simulation.
- Analyzed network traffic and protocol behavior across common attack scenarios to document exploitation mechanics and their corresponding defensive countermeasures.

Enterprise Infrastructure Trainee

Aug 2025 – Sep 2025

General Authority for Investment and Free Zones (GAFI) — Cairo, Egypt

- Reviewed enterprise network infrastructure, routing policies, and Web Application Firewall (WAF) filtering logic to flag configuration weaknesses in production environments.
- Assessed Access Control Lists (ACLs) and perimeter defense mechanisms for resilience against automated scanning tools and common exploit patterns.

HANDS-ON SECURITY PROJECTS

Network Attack & Defense Simulator *(Python, CustomTkinter)*

- Built a modular GUI-based simulator implementing ARP spoofing, packet sniffing, and traffic-manipulation modules, each paired with a matching real-time defensive countermeasure for side-by-side comparison.

Cyber Vault — Cryptographic Credential Manager *(Python)*

- Engineered a secure credential-storage system with Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) and PBKDF2-SHA256 password hashing, designed to resist offline brute-force and credential-stuffing attacks.

Open-Source Security Tooling Portfolio *(GitHub)*

- Maintain **17** public repositories showcasing security tooling, scripting utilities, and coursework projects.

COMPETITIONS & EXTRACURRICULAR ACHIEVEMENTS

- **CyCTF Luxor — Competitor** (Mar 2026). Competed in a live Capture-The-Flag event, solving challenges across mobile security and cryptography categories.
- **ICPC (International Collegiate Programming Contest) Competitor, ECU** (2024, 2025). Competed in two consecutive editions, solving algorithmic problems in C++ under strict contest time limits.

OFFENSIVE SECURITY LABS & COMPETITIONS

- **Hack The Box:** Progressing through the Certified Penetration Testing Specialist (CPTS) path (**15%** complete); compromised Linux and Windows target machines spanning initial access, privilege escalation, and Active Directory attack chains.
- **PortSwigger Web Security Academy:** Solved **30+** labs covering blind SQLi, stored/reflected XSS, SSRF, CSRF, IDOR, and authentication bypass.
- **TryHackMe:** Completed **15+** rooms across dedicated penetration-testing pathways (e.g., Vulniversity, Further Nmap, Linux PrivEsc); earned **4 badges**, ranking in the **top 20%** of all users.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

B.Sc. Computer Science — Cybersecurity Major

The Egyptian Chinese University (ECU), Cairo, Egypt | Expected Graduation: 2027

- HTB Certified Penetration Testing Specialist (CPTS) Path — Hack the Box (In Progress)
- Digital Egypt Builders Initiative (DEBI) — Cybersecurity Track (6-month program; 4 sessions/week, 3 hours each — **300+ hours** total)
- Cisco Cybersecurity Operations & Defense (90 Hours), National Telecommunication Institute (NTI)
- Introduction to Networking (2-week program), NVIDIA Academy & Packet